

Atomic computers

A group of researchers going by the name Nanotechnology Dream Team say they will unveil a revolutionary computer made out of atoms on November 1st, 2011

Future data storage

Holographic data storage is an emerging technology which will enable high density storage of data (500 Gbit/in) and faster data transfer speeds



First Else has a convenient "thumb-based" interface

Swype, a Seattle-based company has launched a new way to type on touch-screen phones without ever lifting your finger. You just slide your finger across the letters at top speed. The software was created by the inventor of the T9 predictive typing system, and is able to predict what word you are typing by tracing your path and the letters that come under your slashes and swipes. In a comparison video on YouTube, the Swype-enabled Samsung Omnia II beats the iPhone by a healthy margin. The web site claims that one is able to achieve an unheard of speed of 40 words a minute on touch screen devices. For us Indians, this will probably mean entering our unique names into the dictionary by tapping traditionally, before we will be able to Swype. It's releasing on Android phones next year.

Reality++

Mobile Augmented Reality is already a reality in the Netherlands. An Amsterdam-based company, SPRXmobile, has come up with an application called Layar – a mobile augmented reality browser that currently works on the Android and the iPhone. It displays real time digital information on top of the reality that the mobile camera sees. While looking through the phone's camera lens, a user can pan around the landscape, and look for houses for sale, restaurants, jobs, healthcare providers and ATMs.

Here's how it works: Starting up the Layar application automatically activates the camera. The embedded GPS automatically knows the location of the phone, and the compass determines in which direction the phone is facing. Each partner provides a set of location coordinates with relevant information, which forms a digital layer that is presented on the phone. "Eventually, the physical and the virtual worlds will become one," said Raimo van der Klein, co-founder of SPRXmobile.

Layar derives information from a variety of location based services – the developer SPRXmobile has partnered with local banks, a realty web site, a social networking web site, an employment agency, and a healthcare provider to provide their location coordinates and other information. Technically, any mobile phone with a camera, GPS and compass should be able to do the same. The company has opened up its platform for developers, to enable third parties to create and publish digital layers within the Layar mobile application.

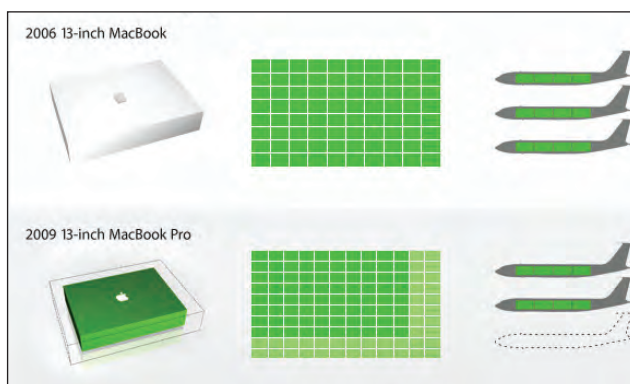
Greener pastures

Neal R. Armstrong, professor at the US-based University of Arizona, which does a lot of research on solar power said this about the world's most popular music player: "You burn about a quarter of a pound of coal per charge of your lithium ion battery, and you generate about half a pound of CO2 per charge, per battery, per day." Apparently the room got really silent after he said that.

Laptops will soon offer you three hours of battery life, some will give seven to ten, others promise a week. Even if consumers aren't interested in going green, it is likely that we will see increased adoption by people who use renew-

able energy to power their infrastructure. These will be consumers who will drive a shift in performance metrics and the benchmarks being used. Homes and offices that run on green or renewable energy would care very much about a monitor that uses 20 per cent less power than its contemporaries.

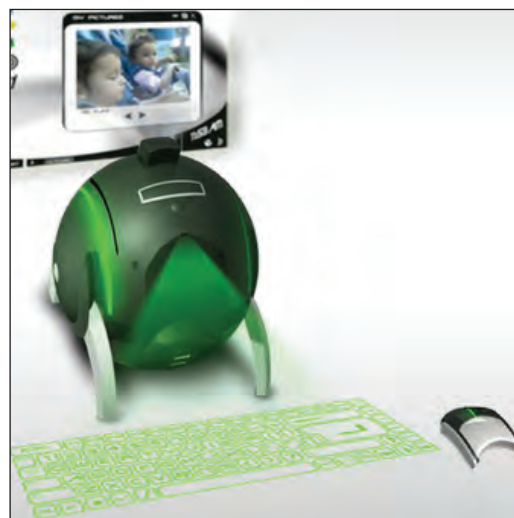
We are also likely to see more environmentally conscious components that will be free of mercury, arsenic, PVC and BFR. Some of the leading consumer electronics



Reduction in packaging

companies try to make products that are recyclable. Many of them collect a product after its lifecycle, and take care of its reuse and disposal.

The gigahertz race pushed the power consumption of desktop processors to outrageous levels, but lately, power efficiency has been given the emphasis it deserves. To a fair extent, computer manufacturers have begun to close in on the gap between



Ready for use